Title III, Part A: District grant application assistance

Overview: Over 1,700 districts have successfully purchased Ellevation using federal funding like Title grants. Federal formula or Title grants are non-competitive; each state receives a portion of the funding based on a formula. States, in turn, pass the funding on to local districts and schools.

Federal funding helps supplement multilingual initiatives and can be used towards the purchases of;

- Ellevation Platform's English learner (EL) program management
- Ellevation Strategies' professional development (PD)

Directions: This document is intended to assist you in applying for Title grants to purchase Ellevation Platform and/or Ellevation Strategies and contains;

- Wording that can be directly used in a grant application, which clearly references the relevant Title statutes. *Please note: Wording may need to be slightly altered at your discretion depending on your purchase.*

- Title III Statute Citations inform justification for why a purchase of Ellevation Platform/ Ellevation Strategies is allowable under the Title III.
    - Sections in bold identify the justification for why a purchase of Ellevation's software is allowable under Title III.

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Wording to use in applications to the state for these funds

You can use the below wording when completing an application to the state for Title III, Part A funding to purchase Ellevation Platform and/or Strategies.

Note: You may need to edit out references to either Platform or Strategies if your district only intends to purchase one of them.

The purposes of Title III (Sec. 3102) and sub grants to LEAs (Sec. 3115(a)) include providing services to ELs to help them attain English proficiency and achieve academically, LEA wide programs for restructuring, reforming, and upgrading all relevant programs, activities, and operations relating to language instruction educational programs and academic content instruction for English learners and immigrant children and youth, and providing professional development to assist teachers, school leaders, and local education agencies to develop and enhance their capacity to provide effective instructional programs designed to prepare English learners, including immigrant children and youth, to enter all-English instructional settings.

Our district plans to purchase Ellevation's software to enhance our capacity to provide effective instructional programs that address the learning needs of our district's ELs. A purchase of Ellevation's software aligns with multiple authorized activities using Title III funds (see Sections 3115(d)(1, 2, 5, 7, & 9)). In addition, professional development of the type Ellevation provides is a required Title III activity (Sec. 3115(c)(2)).
Ellevation's software helps districts to carry out highly focused, innovative, locally designed activities to expand or enhance existing language instruction educational programs and academic content instructional programs for ELs and Immigrant children and youth.

If purchasing Ellevation Platform, include the below:
Ellevation Platform provides all educators in our district access to EL student data, including multiple sets of assessment and instructional data to make important learning decisions and set and monitor goals for our EL students. Additionally, all users have the ability to document key observations and decisions directly in the platform, ensuring effective communication between all of a student's educators.

If purchasing Ellevation Strategies, include the below:
Ellevation Strategies provides professional development modules that are effective in helping teachers and leaders improve instruction, enhance the ability of teachers and leaders to understand and implement strategies, increase teacher subject matter knowledge, teaching knowledge, and teaching skills, and are of sufficient intensity and duration to have a positive and lasting impact on teacher performance.

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Title III Statute Citations

Sections in bold identify the justification for why a purchase of Ellevation's software is allowable under this Title.

- Sec. 3102 The purposes of Title III are—
  - (1) to help ensure that English learners, including immigrant children and youth, **attain English proficiency and develop high levels of academic achievement in English;**
  - (2) to assist all English learners, including immigrant children and youth, to **achieve at high levels in academic subjects** so that all English learners can **meet the same challenging State academic standards that all children are expected to meet**;
  - (3) to **assist** teachers (including preschool teachers), principals and other school leaders, State educational agencies, local educational agencies, and schools in **establishing, implementing, and sustaining effective language instruction educational programs designed to assist in teaching English learners**, including immigrant children and youth;
  - (4) to **assist** teachers (including preschool teachers), principals and other school leaders, State educational agencies, and local educational agencies t**o develop and enhance their capacity to provide effective instructional programs designed to prepare English learners, including immigrant children and youth, to enter all-English instructional settings.**

- Sec. 3115(a) Purposes of Title III Sub Grants to LEAs are — A State educational agency may make a subgrant to an eligible entity from funds received by the agency under Title III only if the entity agrees to expend the funds to i**mprove the education of English learners by assisting the children to learn English and meet the challenging State academic standards.** In carrying out activities with such funds, the eligible entity shall use effective approaches and methodologies for teaching English learners and immigrant children and youth for the following purposes:
  - (1) Developing and implementing new language instruction educational programs and academic content instructional programs for English learners and immigrant children and youth, including early childhood education programs, elementary school programs, and secondary school programs.
  - (2) Carrying out highly focused, innovative, locally designed activities to expand or enhance existing language instruction educational programs and academic content instructional programs for English learners and immigrant children and youth.
  - (3) Implementing, within an individual school, schoolwide programs for restructuring, reforming, and upgrading all relevant programs, activities, and operations relating to language instruction educational programs and academic content instruction for English learners and immigrant children and youth.
  - (4) Implementing, within the entire jurisdiction of a local educational agency, agencywide programs for restructuring, reforming, and upgrading all relevant programs, activities, and operations relating to language instruction educational programs and academic content instruction for English learners and immigrant children and youth.

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- Sec. 3115(c)(2)(A-D) Required Title III Activity: **Districts receiving Title III funds must;**
  - **(2) provide effective professional development to classroom teachers (including teachers in classroom settings that are not the settings of language instruction educational programs), principals and other school leaders, administrators, and other school or community-based organizational personnel**, that is—
    - (A) designed to **improve** the instruction and assessment of English learners;
    - (B) designed to **enhance** the ability of such teachers, principals, and other school leaders to understand and implement curricula, assessment practices and measures, and instructional strategies for English learners;
    - (C) **effective in increasing** children's English language proficiency or **substantially increasing** the subject matter knowledge, teaching knowledge, and teaching skills of such teachers; and
    - (D) of **sufficient intensity and duration** (which shall not include activities such as 1-day or short-term workshops and conferences) **to have a positive and lasting impact on the teachers' performance in the classroom**, except that this subparagraph shall not apply to an activity that is one component of a long-term, comprehensive professional development plan established by a teacher and the teacher's supervisor based on an assessment of the needs of the teacher, the supervisor, the students of the teacher, and any local educational agency employing the teacher, as appropriate.

- Sec. 3115(d)(1, 2, 5, 7, & 9) – (d) Authorized (allowable) Title III Activities.—Subject to subsection (c), an eligible entity receiving Title III funds may use the funds to achieve any of the purposes described in subsection (a) by undertaking one or more of the following activities:
  - (1) **Upgrading** program objectives and effective instructional strategies
  - (2) **Improving the instructional program for English learners by** identifying, **acquiring**, and upgrading curricula, instructional materials, **educational software**, and assessment procedures.
  - (5) **Improving** the English language proficiency and academic achievement of English learners.
  - (7) **Improving the instruction of English learners**, which may include English learners with a disability, **by providing for—**
    - (A) the **acquisition** or development of educational technology or **instructional materials;**
    - (B) **access to**, and participation in, **electronic networks for materials, training**, and communication; and
    - (C) incorporation of the resources described in subparagraphs (A) and (B) into curricula and programs, such as those funded under this subpart.
  - (9) **Carrying out other activities that are consistent with the purposes of this section.**

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